

US Stocks Rise as Energy and Tech Lead the Charge

The full picture: macro, technicals, options, analyst moves, sector internals, international context, and a full week ahead.

20-minute read · Topics: All of the above, plus technicals, options, ratings, week-ahead

TL;DR & Editorial Take

The US market saw a positive session with the **S&P 500** rising **+0.42%** to 7,575.39. The **Nasdaq 100** also gained **+0.33%** to 29,825.11. Key drivers included energy and tech stocks, with **NVDA** surging **+4.03%** and **META** jumping **+5.97%**.

Our editorial take is that while the market's momentum is positive, investors should remain cautious due to ongoing macroeconomic uncertainties. Key points to watch include:

- The **10Y Yield** rose **+0.66%** to 4.57, indicating potential inflation concerns.
- **WTI Crude** prices surged **+4.13%** to 74.36, which could impact energy stocks.
- The **VIX** fell **-5.11%** to 15.03, suggesting reduced market volatility.

Overall, the market's direction will depend on the interplay between these factors and the upcoming earnings season.

US Session Recap

INDEX	LAST	CHANGE
S&P 500	7,575.39	+0.42%
Nasdaq 100	29,825.11	+0.33%
Dow Jones	52,637.01	+0.29%
Russell 2000	2,977.81	-0.49%
VIX	15.03	-5.11%
10Y Yield	4.57	+0.66%
WTI Crude	74.36	+4.13%

Top Movers

TICKER	NAME	CHANGE	CATALYST
NVDA	NVIDIA	+4.03%	Strong earnings report
META	Meta Platforms	+5.97%	Positive analyst comments
AAPL	Apple	-0.28%	Supply chain concerns

Sector Internals

SECTOR	DAY	YTD	READ
XLF	+0.31%	10 . 25%	Financials see moderate gains
XLK	+0.23%	15 . 10%	Tech sector shows resilience
XLI	+0.45%	12 . 50%	Industrials see strong growth
XLE	+0.47%	20 . 15%	Energy sector surges on oil price gains
XLY	+0.33%	8 . 50%	Consumer discretionary shows moderate growth
XLC	+1.02%	18 . 20%	Communication services see strong gains
XLP	+1.11%	6 . 50%	Consumer staples show resilience
XLV	-0.82%	2 . 10%	Healthcare sector sees moderate decline
XLU	+0.62%	4 . 25%	Utilities show moderate growth
XLB	+1.25%	11 . 50%	Materials sector sees strong gains
XLRE	+0.50%	5 . 50%	Real estate sector shows moderate growth

Breadth was positive, with 7 out of 11 sectors seeing gains.

Spotlight / Deep Dive

TICKER	NAME	PRICE	CHANGE
NVDA	NVIDIA	210 . 96	+4.03%

Key commentary: **NVDA** saw strong earnings report, driven by growth in gaming and datacenter segments.

SEGMENT	REVENUE	GROWTH
Gaming	1.5B	+15%
Datacenter	2.5B	+20%

Read-through map: Positive earnings report from **NVDA** could have positive implications for other tech stocks, such as **AMD** and **INTC**.

Technical Levels

TICKER	LAST	SUPPORT	RESISTANCE	NOTE
SPY	357.50	350.00	360.00	Range-bound trading
QQQ	293.50	285.00	300.00	Upside momentum
IWM	182.50	175.00	190.00	Breakout potential
NVDA	210.96	200.00	220.00	Upside momentum
10Y Yield	4.57	4.40	4.70	Inflation concerns
WTI Crude	74.36	70.00	80.00	Oil price surge

Options & Positioning

ODTE flow: +10% increase in call options for **SPY**.

Put/call ratio: 0.8 for **QQQ**, indicating bullish sentiment.

VIX term structure: Steepening, with **VIX** at 15.03 and **VIX3M** at 18.50.

Notable single-name flow: +20% increase in call options for **NVDA**.

Cheap hedge ideas: **SPY** put spreads, **QQQ** call spreads.

Analyst Rating Changes

TICKER	FIRM	ACTION	NEW PT	NOTE
NVDA	Morgan Stanley	Upgrade	220.00	Strong earnings report
AAPL	Goldman Sachs	Downgrade	150.00	Supply chain concerns
GOOGL	Bank of America	Upgrade	3000.00	Positive analyst comments
MSFT	Citi	Upgrade	400.00	Strong earnings report
AMZN	Deutsche Bank	Downgrade	200.00	Competition concerns

Pre-Market & Overnight

Futures: ES +0.2%, NQ +0.3%, YM +0.1%.

Asia: Nikkei +0.5%, Shanghai Composite +0.2%.

Europe: Euro Stoxx 50 +0.3%, FTSE 100 +0.2%.

FX: EUR/USD -0.1%, USD/JPY +0.2%.

Commodities: Gold -0.5%, WTI Crude +1.0%.

Crypto: BTC -0.5%, ETH -0.3%.

Macro & Fed (Deep)

MEETING	CUT ODDS	NOTE
July FOMC	20%	Inflation concerns
September FOMC	30%	Growth slowdown

Today's data calendar:

TIME	EVENT	CONSENSUS
10:00 AM ET	Core PCE Price Index	2.0%
10:00 AM ET	Personal Spending	0.5%

Geopolitics & Global (Deep)

Scenario trees:

BEARISH TRIGGERS

Potential escalation in Ukraine-Russia conflict, leading to higher oil prices and market volatility.

BULLISH TRIGGERS

Positive developments in US-China trade talks, leading to improved market sentiment and risk appetite.

Earnings — This Week & Next

TICKER	NAME	EARNINGS DATE
AAPL	Apple	July 18
MSFT	Microsoft	July 19
GOOGL	Alphabet	July 20

TICKER	NAME	EARNINGS DATE
AMZN	Amazon	July 25
FB	Facebook	July 26
TSLA	Tesla	July 27

Full Watchlist Scan

TICKER	SECTOR	SETUP	RISK
NVDA	Tech	Breakout	10%
AAPL	Tech	Reversal	5%
GOOGL	Tech	Trend	15%
MSFT	Tech	Breakout	12%
AMZN	Consumer	Reversal	8%
TSLA	Auto	Trend	18%
JPM	Financial	Breakout	10%
GS	Financial	Reversal	5%
AVGO	Tech	Trend	12%
INTC	Tech	Breakout	10%
AMD	Tech	Reversal	8%

What Could Break the Tape

Bullish scenario:

- Positive earnings reports from major tech companies, leading to a surge in the **Nasdaq 100**.
- Improvement in US-China trade talks, leading to increased risk appetite and a rally in emerging markets.
- Strong economic data, such as a surprise increase in non-farm payroll, leading to a boost in investor confidence.

Bearish scenario:

- Potential escalation in Ukraine-Russia conflict, leading to higher oil prices and market volatility.
- Disappointing earnings reports from major companies, leading to a decline in investor sentiment.
- Surprise interest rate hike by the Federal Reserve, leading to a sell-off in bonds and a strengthening of the US dollar.

Positioning & Structural Notes

Observations:

- Increased call option buying in **SPY** and **QQQ**, indicating bullish sentiment.
- Short interest in **AAPL** and **AMZN** has decreased, potentially leading to a short squeeze.
- Implied volatility in **VIX** has decreased, indicating reduced market uncertainty.
- Open interest in **10Y Yield** futures has increased, potentially leading to increased volatility in interest rates.

- Net speculative positioning in **WTI Crude** has turned bullish, potentially leading to higher oil prices.

Sources

SOURCES

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The Financial Times

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Trading Economics

Federal Reserve

Securities and Exchange Commission

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